

Hellenic World :-

What is Hellenic world?

The term Hellenic refers specifically to the classical Greek world - before the expansion of Greek culture by Alexander the Great. It span from around 800 BCE to 323 BCE (the death of Alexander).

It represent the pure Greek cultural and political era centered around the city states like Athens, Sparta, Corinth, Thebes and others.

Key Features of the Hellenic world :-

- 1- City - States (Poleis) :-
 - Independent and self-governing :- Each had its own laws, currency, army and form of government (democracy in Athens, Oligarchy in Sparta). They often formed leagues and alliances but also competed and went to war frequently.
- 2- Politics and Government :- Athenian democracy was a major development - citizens could vote and participate directly in law making. Other city-states had monarchies, tyrannies or oligarchies. Despite rivalries shared festivals and sanctuaries (like Delphi and Olympia) helped to maintain a sense of unity.

3- Religion and Myth:- Polytheistic religion with gods who had human traits.

major gods:- Zeus, Athena, Apollo and Hera etc

myths and legends were central to literature, ritual and identity.

4- Philosophy and learning:- The Hellenic world was the birthplace of Western philosophy. Socrates - ethics and critical thinking. Plato - idealism and political theory. Aristotle - logic, science and practical philosophy.

Centers of learning: Athens (Academy, Lyceum).

5- Art and Architecture:-

Architecture:- Doric, Ionic, Corinthian styles

Sculpture:- idealized human forms, balance and proportion.

Drama:- Greek tragedy and comedy (Aeschylus, Sophocles, Euripides, Aristophanes)

Poetry:- Homer's epics (Iliad and Odyssey)

6- Warfare and Conflicts:- Frequent wars between city states.

Persian Wars (490-479 BCE) united Greek city-states defeated the powerful Persian Empire.

Peloponnesian War (431-404 BCE) devastating war between Athens and Sparta.

Warfare was primarily fought by hoplites in a phalanx formation.

7- Economy and Trade:- Based on agriculture, craftsmanship and trade.
Traded across the Mediterranean and Black Seas.

Athen became a wealthy naval power due to its strong merchant fleet & silver mines.

End of the Hellenic Period:-

The Hellenic era ended with the rise of Macedon under Philip I and his son Alexander the Great. After Alexander's conquest (323 BCE) the Hellenistic period began, when Greek culture blended with Egyptian, Persian and Asian influences across a much larger empire.